



MONTHLY UPDATE

Congo: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-18 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

Revenue systems and the payroll carried the month. The public-revenue platform [went live for online payment of taxes, levies and customs duties after its pilot cohort completed](#), while the treasury single account meant to [centralise those receipts was still being finalised on the day it opened](#) — a collection rail running ahead of the account it collects into.

The payroll is where the record is unusually candid. Its operator's minutes and a Senate disclosure [put duplicate payroll numbers and deceased or retired staff still drawing salaries on the record](#), with an integrated civil-status system presented as the structural fix, its software validated and its deployment unfunded. Elsewhere customs digitalisation [was handed to a Nigerian firm on a 20-year, US\\$3.1bn concession signed at Abuja](#), and a public-administration digitalisation task force [was gazetted on 6 August](#) with no session yet on record.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

The education ministry's digital roadmap [was validated at a Brazzaville workshop on 19 August](#). Validated is not adopted: no text, budget line, sequencing or implementing body is published with it.

Regional collaboration

The broadcasting regulator and its counterpart across the river [signed a memorandum formalising their partnership after two days of work on 19 and 20 August](#). No text, scope or commencement is published, so what the repository holds is that two regulators have agreed to cooperate.

A seminar with the DRC [closed with a Brazzaville Declaration urging digitalised migration and customs procedures along the 2,400km border](#); it binds neither government.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The month's governance news is a prosecution. An international observatory [recorded continued judicial harassment of the defender Ghislain Ondeke Kanga and the opening of his trial](#). The record held carries no state response to the account.

Finance

New investments

A number was put on the sector's future. Consultancy forecasts reported by the state news agency [attribute more than 800 billion of gross domestic product to the digital economy within five years](#). It is a projection carried by the state agency, not a measurement, and the record held carries no current figure for the sector's contribution against which to read it.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The universal access and service fund put a cumulative figure on the record for the first time: [more than 380,000 people in formerly isolated areas now have communication infrastructure, and more than 250 localities are better linked to urban centres and essential services](#). The figure was given at a regional workshop on emergency telecommunications, where the country's own plan is still to be written; it covers the fund's whole life rather than the period, and the fund has published no annual series against which to read it.

Data Storage

The published roadmap names [sovereign hosting and connectivity at the two highest tiers](#) among its infrastructure programmes; neither exists, with no standing-up instrument, host body, budget or date.

The national data centre remains a thing asserted rather than reported. On 10 August the state operator [showed the minister a real-time security operations centre running across its Brazzaville, Pointe-Noire and Oyo data centres](#), alongside nationwide fibre connectivity for citizens, businesses and state bodies. It is the fullest description of the operator's estate the repository holds, and it is still a ministerial visit rather than an inauguration report: no capacity, certification or utilisation figure is given for any of the three sites, and nothing reconciles it with the [works reported suspended at 95% completion in late 2025](#).

Cybersecurity

It [launched an open international tender on 23 July for a 24-month mission to draft the national cybersecurity strategy, a national training plan and national conferences](#), scope covering a sector diagnostic, a strategic roadmap and a standing forum; no contract value is published. On 28 July it [validated a consolidated draft setting qualification conditions for bodies authorised to audit information systems nationally](#), with no adoption instrument, publication date or entry into force stated. Its largest operational mandate arrived through tax legislation: a [decree of 31 March, published 9 July, puts the agency into joint homologation of every invoicing terminal, software and enterprise module](#); it awards the security label and conformity identifier, audits the infrastructure and takes [15% of homologation fees](#). The same roadmap also names a [national security operations centre and response team](#) among its infrastructure programmes; it does not exist either.

What the regulator does have is an enforcement record. It [dismantled a sixth SIM box fraud network of the year on 21 August in the Massengo district of Brazzaville, seizing two 16-port SIM boxes, a modem, a laptop and an automatic battery-recharging system, recovering 30 Ugandan numbers in fraudulent use and arresting two people, and puts that network's loss at about FCFA 42m over two months on more than 422,000 diverted call minutes](#). The estimate and the method behind it are the regulator's own, and no prosecution outcome is on record.

DPI

Data Exchange

One exchange went into use, in the narrow place where the state examines itself. The national transparency commission [opened the second round of its public-finance transparency-code evaluation entirely online, covering budget years 2023 to 2025](#), focal-point training having completed in Brazzaville beforehand. No supplier, custodian or results-publication date is stated, and the platform is not publicly accessible on the record held.

The larger exchange was contracted out. Customs-procedure digitalisation under the continental free-trade agreement [was awarded to a Nigerian firm on a 20-year concession valued at US\\$3.1bn, signed at Abuja](#). No revenue share, data-ownership term or exit provision is published for a twenty-year hold over the state's customs data.

Digital Identity and CRVS

The credential layer moved on stock rather than on design: the government [announced 100,000 blank passports and a new payment mechanism, alongside 330,000 identity cards](#). The instrument behind the card is older — [Decret 2024-2692 of 21 November 2024 institutes the computerised national identity card](#) — and the unique identification number it rests on has been instituted since 2004. What the repository still does not hold is an issuance series against those volumes.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 3 August the [public-revenue platform went live on the national payments switch](#), payment following a declaration, authenticated, reconciled in real time and routed to the treasury against a secured electronic receipt. Roll-out runs at large then medium enterprises, all taxpayers targeted by end-2026 and no wave dates published. The same account records the [treasury single account at the regional central bank still being finalised](#).

Registries

The minister recorded on 10 July that the [regulator has run the postal addressing project for two years and the ministry has not taken it up for deployment](#), his own framing being that without the handover the work has not had the expected impact. The registry that does have a system waiting for it went before the Senate. On 7 August the interior minister [said ministry and municipal staff are themselves among those running networks selling forged civil-status documents, and announced investigations to dismantle them](#), naming the integrated civil-status system as the structural fix; the ministers [set out the platform as the way to centralise birth, marriage and death records](#). Its three modules were validated in February and its deployment is still unfunded, so what changed this month is the case made for it rather than its build state.

Control arrived before the system did. A [circular of 1 September 2026 from the territorial administration bans antedating of civil-status acts and changes of identity or filiation without a court decision](#). It is an administrative control placed on a paper process while the validated integrated civil-status software waits for deployment funding, and no volume of irregular acts is published to say how large the problem it addresses is.

Sectoral management information systems

Health acquired equipment rather than a system. On 7 August the Global Fund and UNDP [handed over e-health equipment, a P2-level biosafety laboratory and a secure biomedical-waste management system at the Edith Lucie Bongo Ondimba hospital at Oyo](#), for early disease detection, patient data management and health-service coordination. It is a single site; no value, system name, national rollout or interoperability with any other health system is stated, and it sits beside a civil-service payroll platform whose own operator has minuted three failure

modes. That platform gained a fourth problem in public: the public service minister [told the Senate on 7 August of fraudulent duplicate payroll numbers and of deceased or retired staff still drawing salaries](#). No count, value or remedy is stated, and the disclosure is the minister's own.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

A public-administration digitalisation task force [was gazetted on 6 August, as decree 2026-261 of 29 July 2026](#). No session of it is on record, and the decree names no deliverable, deadline or budget — an instrument creating a body, with the work still to be defined.

Capacity

Research institutions

Researchers and faculty met in Brazzaville on 21 and 22 August to [set rules for the use of artificial intelligence in research](#). No code, guideline text or adopting institution has come out of it yet.

Inclusion

Access to services

The state-control ministry publishes an [online channel for reporting irregularities in public administration](#), taking reports of corruption, misappropriation of public funds, favouritism, poor service quality, unexplained absence of officials and excessive delay, under a stated confidentiality guarantee. The page carries no date of its own and no figure for reports received or resolved, so what the repository holds is that the channel exists.

Data

National statistics

The quarterly labour-market and informal-sector survey moved from preparation into regional alignment: a [harmonisation workshop opened on 19 August, running to 27 August, on aligning the region's labour statistics with international standards](#). Four series of indicators a year are planned, a first for the country, and no fieldwork date, sample or budget is stated.

Use of satellite data

The national mapping institute began putting its own holdings into a usable form. On 11 August it [signed a framework partnership with a local non-governmental organisation to digitise, secure and disseminate its geospatial and cartographic data](#), building a shared platform for public, institutional and research access. It is a framework agreement rather than a delivered platform: no term, funding, licence or access rule is stated, and nothing says what is currently held or in what form.

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